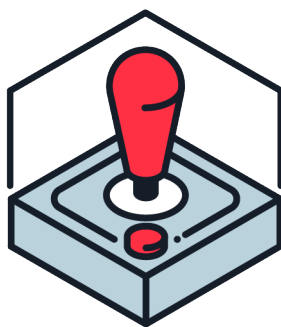




Video Game Metadata Schema: Controlled Vocabulary for **GAMEPLAY GENRE**

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GAMER
GAME RESEARCH GROUP

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Version History

1.1: June 2015

1.2: September 2020

1.3: September 2024

1.3: December 2024, Formatting update: Updated reference structure for improved visual clarity and ease of use, with no changes to content. Table formatting was removed, and relationships between terms are now displayed hierarchically through indentation, with narrower terms shown as subsets of broader terms. Included relevant term relationships (SN, USE, USE FOR, BT, NT, RT) as appropriate.

Abbreviation Key

The following abbreviations are used throughout:

SN: Scope note

USE: Preferred term (See)

USE FOR: Equivalent term, lead-in term

BT: Broader term

NT: Narrower term

RT: Related term (See also)

Controlled Vocabulary for Gameplay Genre

Action

SN: Games that revolve around a fast-paced experience. These games often emphasize reaction-based challenges in terms of how the player interacts with the game world

NT: **Action-Adventure, Arcade, Block Breaking, Brawler, Fighting, Hack and Slash, Multiplayer Online Battle Arena, Music, Party, Platform, Stealth, Survival, Vehicle Combat**

Action-Adventure

SN: Games which focus more on a sense of adventure than fast-paced conflict, often with a focus on solving riddles or overcoming challenges to progress. Representative games are *Myst* and *The Amazon Trail*.

USE FOR: **Adventure**

BT: **Action**

Adventure

USE: **Action-Adventure**

Arcade

SN: Games that either were released in a classic arcade setting or have their artistic roots in that aesthetic. These games often have simple graphics and gameplay with a focus on attaining a high score. Representative games are *Pac-Man* and *Space Invaders*.

BT: **Action**

Beat 'Em Up

USE: **Brawler**

Block Breaking

SN: Games where the primary mechanic for advancement and scoring is the breaking of blocks, often with a ball controlled by a paddle. Representative games are *Brickles* and *3-D Brickaway*.

BT: **Action**

Brawler

SN: Games focusing on physical hand-to-hand combat, sometimes allowing players to use parts of the environment as weapons. Characters often engage with multiple enemies simultaneously to fight through levels. Representative games are *Double Dragon* and *The Bouncer*.

USE FOR: **Beat 'Em Up**

BT: **Action**

RT: **Hack and Slash**

Car Combat

USE: **Vehicle Combat**

Fighting

SN: Games where the player controls a character or team of characters engaging in physical combat with others. They employ rounds, with the winner of the majority deciding the match. Often feature diverse characters with unique fighting styles. Representative games are *Street Fighter 2* and *King of Fighters*.

BT: **Action**

NT: **Mascot Fighter**

Mascot Fighter

SN: Games featuring mascot characters, often from game or media franchises, engaging in combat in the style of fighting games. Usually involve more than two characters fighting simultaneously in a free-for-all environment. Representative games are *Super Smash Brothers* and PlayStation *All-Stars Battle Royale*.

BT: **Fighting**

Hack and Slash

SN: Games focusing on fast-paced gameplay involving melee weapons. Players often fight multiple enemies simultaneously to advance across levels. Representative games are *Gauntlet Legends* and *Golden Axe*.

BT: **Action**

RT: **Brawler**

Multiplayer Online Battle Arena

SN: Games focusing on a third-person perspective where players control a single character in an online environment. Often feature teams competing to achieve goals or domination. Representative games are *League of Legends* and *Defense of the Ancients*.

USE FOR: **MOBA**

BT: **Action**

Music

SN: Games revolving around music, beats, or rhythm as a core part of their experience. Some feature control of simulated instruments like guitars and drums. Representative games are *Hi-Fi Rush* and *Rock Band*.

BT: **Action**

NT: **Dancing**

Dancing

SN: Games where players interact by moving or dancing on an external peripheral. Representative game is *Dance Dance Revolution*.

BT: **Music**

RT: **Rhythm**

Party

SN: Games that are collections of smaller “mini-games,” often meant for group play in a casual competitive context. Representative games are *Mario Party* and *Wii Party*.

USE FOR: **Minigame Collection**

BT: **Action**

Platform

SN: Games focusing on jumping or moving between platforms, navigating terrain and obstacles, emphasizing hand-eye coordination. Representative games are *Super Mario Bros. 3* and *Sonic the Hedgehog*.

USE FOR: **Platformer**

BT: **Action**

Stealth

SN: Games emphasizing stealth and avoiding detection. Representative games are *Metal Gear Solid* and *Tenchu: Stealth Assassins*.

BT: **Action**

Survival

SN: Games focusing on surviving difficult situations, often emphasizing resource management (like health and ammunition) against overwhelming opposition. Representative games are *Left 4 Dead* and *Don't Starve*.

BT: **Action**

Vehicle Combat

SN: Games focusing on combat between vehicles as a key mechanic. Representative games are *Twisted Metal* and *Burnout*.

USE FOR: **Car Combat**

BT: **Action**

Minigame Collection

USE: **Party**

MOBA

USE: **Multiplayer Online Battle Arena**

Platformer

USE: **Platform**

Puzzle

SN: Games that emphasize solving puzzles and/or organizing pieces. Representative games are *Lumines* and *Portal*.

NT: **Block Fill, Hidden Object, Match Puzzles, Point and Click, Word Puzzles**

Block Fill

SN: Games where players strategically place or arrange blocks to fill spaces or complete patterns, aiming to clear lines or match shapes. Representative games are *Tetris* and *Puyo Pop Fever*.

BT: **Puzzle**

Hidden Object

SN: Games where players search for specific items concealed within detailed scenes to progress. Representative game is *The Witness*.

BT: **Puzzle**

Match Puzzles

SN: Games where players align or group identical items (like tiles or gems) in sets, typically of three or more, to clear them and achieve objectives. Representative games are *Candy Crush* and *Bejeweled 3*.

BT: **Puzzle**

Point and Click

SN: Games where players interact by clicking on objects, collecting items and information to solve puzzles and advance the narrative. Representative games are *Deponia* and *The Secret of Monkey Island*.

BT: **Puzzle**

RT: **Adventure**

Word Puzzles

SN: Puzzle-based games challenging players to form, decipher, or manipulate words or letters, testing vocabulary and language skills. Representative game is *WORDLE*.

BT: **Puzzle**

Rhythm

SN: These games involve the player inputting commands or completing actions while synchronizing to a rhythm. Representative games are *Space Channel 5* and *Donkey Conga*.

RT: **Music**

Role-Playing

SN: Games related to tabletop role-playing, involving a heavy focus on statistical advancement (like “leveling up”) of characters, combined with exploration.

USE FOR: **RPG**

NT: **Japanese RPG, Massively Multiplayer Online RPG, Rogue-Like, Western RPG**

Japanese RPG

SN: RPGs often designed in Japan, placing heavy focus on visual style and story elements, frequently involving romance and dramatic personal histories. Characters often show anime influence. Representative games are *Final Fantasy 7* and *Dragon Quest*.

USE FOR: **JRPG**

BT: **Role-Playing**

JRPG

USE: **Japanese RPG**

Massively Multiplayer Online RPG

SN: RPGs played with a massive number of players in an online environment. Representative games are *World of Warcraft* and *Star Wars: Knights of the Old Republic*.

USE FOR: **MMORPG**

BT: **Role-Playing**

MMORPG

USE: **Massively Multiplayer Online RPG**

Rogue-Like

SN: RPGs where players explore usually randomly generated environments, focusing on item discovery and permanent character death. Representative games are *Angband* and *Diablo*.

USE FOR: **Rogue RPG**

BT: **Role-Playing**

Rogue RPG

USE: **Rogue-Like**

Western RPG

SN: RPGs focusing on character customization and development, often employing realistic visual styles and vast open worlds. Representative games are *The Elder Scrolls V: Skyrim* and *Baldur's Gate*.

BT: **Role-Playing**

Simulation

SN: Games designed to simulate actions or situations from either an existing or fictional reality.

NT: **Breeding, Construction & Management Simulation, Flight Simulator, God Game, Interactive Movie, Programming Game, Sandbox, Social Simulator, Virtual Life, Visual Novel**

Breeding

SN: Games emphasizing the breeding and development or raising of animals or entities. Representative games are *Spore* and *Monster Rancher*.

BT: **Simulation**

City Building

USE: **Construction & Management Simulation**

Construction & Management Simulation

SN: Games revolving around creating structures, cities, or other built objects, often emphasizing resource management. Representative games are *SimCity 2000* and *Dwarf Fortress*.

USE FOR: **City Building, Tycoon**

BT: **Simulation**

Flight Simulator

SN: Games designed to simulate flight, usually of aircraft. Some strive for realism, while others are more action-oriented. Representative games are *Microsoft Flight Simulator* and *Ace Combat*.

USE FOR: **Aviation Simulator**

BT: **Simulation**

God Game

SN: Games allowing the player to interact with a world as an all-powerful entity.

Representative games are *Black & White* and *Viva Piñata*.

BT: **Simulation**

Interactive Movie

SN: Games involving minimal player action, functioning more as a series of movies controlled through decisions. Representative game is *Night Trap*.

BT: **Simulation**

Life Simulation Game

USE: **Social Simulator**

Open World (Sandbox)

USE: **Sandbox**

Programming Game

SN: Games revolving around programming, often computer code, as their core mechanic. Representative game is *CodeCombat*.

BT: **Simulation**

Sandbox

SN: Games involving open environments where players are encouraged to explore, act, and create freely. Can be played in various ways depending on the player's mood. Representative games are *Minecraft* and *Grand Theft Auto*.

USE FOR: **Open World**

BT: **Simulation**

Social Simulator

SN: Games revolving around simulating social life, situations, and interaction. Representative game is *The Sims*.

USE FOR: **Life Simulation Game**

BT: **Simulation**

Tycoon

USE: **Construction & Management Simulation**

Virtual Life

SN: Games involving the creation of an in-game avatar controlled by the player in a virtual world, living a simulated life, often online with interactions between player avatars. Example game is *Second Life*.

BT: **Simulation**

Visual Novel

SN: Narrative-driven games where players engage with a story primarily through text and visuals, making choices that influence the plot's direction and outcome. Representative games are *Doki Doki Literature Club!* and *VA-11 Hall-A*.

BT: **Simulation**

Sports

SN: For sports games, assign both the term "sports" as well as the name of the sport being represented. Use information associated with the item (e.g., packaging) to provide the sport name and spelling when possible. If no related information is available, use the most common spelling of that sport for the region the record is being created for (e.g., American English for records in the United States). Representative games are *FIFA International Soccer* and *MLB: The Show 24*.

NT: **Racing**

Racing

SN: Games revolving around racing as the core mechanic, often involving vehicles racing around a course. Representative games are *Gran Turismo* and *Forza Motorsport*.

BT: **Sports**

Shooter

SN: Games revolving around a shooting mechanic where players target and shoot objects or enemies to progress.

NT: **First Person Shooter, Light Gun Shooter**

Combat

USE: **Tactical Shooter**

First Person Shooter

SN: Games focusing on shooting mechanics from a first-person perspective. Representative games are *Halo: Combat Evolved* and *Doom*.

USE FOR: **FPS**

BT: **Shooter**

NT: **Massively Multiplayer FPS**

Massively Multiplayer FPS

SN: First-person shooters played in an online environment with massive numbers of players simultaneously. Representative games are *PlanetSide* and *Firefall*.

BT: **First Person Shooter**

FPS

USE: **First Person Shooter, Light Gun Shooter, Rail Shooter, Tactical Shooter**

Light Gun Shooter

SN: Games played using an external gun controller aimed at the screen to shoot objects or enemies. Representative games are *Duck Hunt* and *House of the Dead 2*.

BT: **Shooter**

Rail Shooter

SN: Shooters where players do not control their movement but are propelled along a set course or "rail." Representative games are *The Lost World: Jurassic Park* and *Star Fox 64*.

BT: **Shooter**

Shoot 'em Up

USE: **Shooter**

Tactical Shooter

SN: Games focusing on simulating tactical or military environments, revolving around shooting mechanics. Representative games are *Rainbow Six* and *Call of Duty: Modern Warfare*.

BT: **Shooter**

USE FOR: **Combat**

Strategy

SN: Games revolving around strategic or tactical planning, often involving building, resource management, and exploration components.

NT: **4X, Military Simulator, Real Time Strategy, Tactics, Tower Defense, Turn-Based Strategy**

4X

SN: Stands for "explore, expand, exploit, and exterminate." Games revolve around creating an empire through diplomacy and conquest. Representative games are *Master of Orion* and *Sid Meier's Civilization V*.

BT: **Strategy**

Military Simulator

SN: games focusing on simulating realistic militaries or historical military events. Representative games are *Combat Mission* and *Close Combat*.

USE FOR: **Wargame**

BT: **Strategy**

Real-Time

SN: games unfolding in real-time, as opposed to using turns. Example games are *StarCraft* and *Command and Conquer*.

BT: **Strategy**

Tactics

SN: Games focusing on small-scale conflicts, often involving the player positioning and controlling a predetermined number of units. Representative games are *Final Fantasy Tactics* and *Steel Panthers*.

BT: **Strategy**

Tower Defense

SN: Games focusing on defending a location against waves of enemies, requiring strategic placement and control of units and weapons. Representative game is *Plants vs. Zombies*.

BT: **Strategy**

Turn-Based Strategy

SN: games utilizing alternating turns as the central mechanic. Representative games are *Heroes of Might and Magic* and *Rome: Total War*.

BT: **Strategy**

Wargame

USE: **Military Simulator**

Traditional

SN: Games based on mechanics that exist in the real world and can be played in a physical setting.

NT: **Board Game, Card Game, Exercise, Gambling, Game Show, Maze, Pinball, Puzzle, Trivia Game**

Board Game

SN: Games originating from tabletop board games, often adaptations of existing ones. Representative games are *Settlers of Catan* and *Chessmaster*.

BT: **Traditional**

Card Game

SN: Games originating from tabletop card games, often adaptations of existing ones. Representative games are *Magic: The Gathering* and *Full House Poker*.

BT: **Traditional**

Exercise

SN: Games involving player movement using an external peripheral for physical exercise purposes. Representative game is *Wii Fit*.

BT: **Traditional**

Gambling

SN: Games originating from traditional gambling and casino games, often adaptations. Representative games are *Caesar's Palace* and *Golden Nugget 64*.

BT: **Traditional**

Game Show

SN: Games modeled after, and often adaptations of, television game shows. Representative games are *Jeopardy! The Video Game* and *Wheel of Fortune*.

BT: **Traditional**

RT: **Trivia Game**

Maze

SN: Games revolving around the navigation of a maze. Representative game is *Labyrinth*.

BT: **Traditional**

Pinball

SN: Simulations of pinball machines. Representative games are *Full Tilt Pinball* and *Mario Pinball Land*.

BT: **Traditional**

Trivia Game

SN: Games involving answering questions based on obscure knowledge. Representative games are *The Guy Game* and *Scene It? Box Office Smash*.

USE FOR: **Quiz Game**

BT: **Traditional**

RT: **Game Show**

Quiz Game

USE: **Trivia Game**